Girnar in the Junagadh district of Gujarat, some thirty metres on the north-eastern face of a large granite boulder shows all fourteen edicts. The writing is uniform, arranged in neat columns. Each of the edicts appears to be divided from the other by straight lines. The various cartouches, carved into clear compartments, can still be clearly seen. It seems plausible that this was ordered to be written at a single point in time, when all fourteen texts were available. Since the composition of the edicts was more usually a staggered process, instances of inscriptional simultaneity would seem to suggest they were set down later. All the edict texts will have had to first be available in finished form to be set down together in a single engraving campaign.[21] So, Girnar is likely to have got its edicts after those at Shahbazgarhi and Kalsi, to which successive batches had been sent.



Fig. 8.3: Rock edicts arranged in columns at Girnar

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